From widespread comments, it becomes obvious that thousands of Israelis will not report for reserve duty when called up, if the judicial reform gets through. They will refuse to serve under a dictatorship. Such civilian disobedience took place in Israel, on a small scale, during the Second Lebanon War. This time, refusal may be more important by far—and it may be dangerous.

Yaya Fink, an observant Jew, repelled by the Huwara rampage and the fact that many religious Jews were among the arsonists, launched a fundraising campaign for those Palestinians who suffered damages. Within twelve hours, some $465,000 was collected. Of course, Fink was called a traitor by the opposite side and received death threats.

This evening, 120 former and present leaders of American Jewry called on Jewish organizations not to give a public platform to Smotrich during his planned visit to the States later this month. Unfortunately, the "Bonds" which invited him—as they have every Israeli finance minister in the past, to energize the sale of Israel state bonds—have not rescinded their invitation. In any case, no US official will meet with the minister. As for Netanyahu, he has not yet been invited to meet Biden, a very unusual situation for a newly elected Israeli prime minister and, supposedly, a "friend" of the president.

Saturday, March 4

A group of senior congressional Democrats has addressed a letter to the president asking him to use all his influence to stop the judicial reform in Israel. They foresee quite correctly that if the reform is voted, the ultras will be able to push through the annexation of the West Bank with unforeseeable and catastrophic consequences for Israel, the Palestinians, and the whole region. They are circulating the letter to add many more signatories (a copy of it reached the Israeli news outlets).